

mistakes, and we absolutely should be able to talk about money in that space. Given the complexity of the role that money plays in our lives, and how many other issues it affects and is affected by, it's puzzling to think that 'financial therapy' is not a thing in the same way that 'couples therapy' is. In my view, there is a gap in the market for professional therapists with a thorough understanding of money, who would be able to offer a holistic approach to personal finance, as well as helping clients to heal the wounds left by financial trauma and catastrophic mistakes. In my own personal experience, talking therapy has helped me to show myself some much-needed compassion, and to identify misplaced guilt that I've been carrying. When you consider that these are both incredibly high hurdles in others' relationships with money, the concept of financial therapy starts to make real sense.

I spoke to Jo Love, mental health ambassador and author of *Therapy is Magic*,⁸ about the benefits of therapy for people struggling to make peace with their finances:

CS: Although still sometimes stigmatized, it feels like we're getting to a place where therapy is more normalized for certain life struggles – but I'm not sure that it occurs to many people to seek a therapist when struggling in their relationship with money. Why do you think that is? And what can we do to change it?

JL: It is true, people are starting to talk much more about accessing therapy and slowly that stigma is starting to